| | Nursing action | Rationale |
|---|---|---|
| 9 | Secure elastic band around patient's head. | Ensure comfort of patient. |
| 10 | Apply padding behind ears as well as scalp where elastic band passes. | Padding prevents irritation to skin around area. |
| 11 | Ensure that safety precautions are followed | |
| 12 | Inspect patient and equipment frequently for flow rate clinical condition, level of water in humidifier, etc | Identifies complications if they develop. |
| 13 | Wash Hands. | Reduces risk of transmission of microorganisms. |
| 14 | Remove the mask and dry the skin every 2-3 hours if oxygen is administered continuously. Do not put powder around the mask. | The tight fitting mask and moisture from condensation can irritate the skin on the face. |
| 15 | Document relevant data in patient's record. | |

## Special Considerations

1. The dosage of oxygen may be ordered as an FIO (Fraction of Inspired Oxygen) which is expressed as a percentage or as liters per minute.
2. The venture mask will have colour-coded inserts that list the flow rate necessary to obtain the desired percentage oxygen.

**Flow rates and oxygen concentrations delivered using venturi mask**

| Nazzelcolour code | Flow rate (Litres per minute) | Concentration of oxygen to be delivered |
|---|---|---|
| Blue | 3 Lpm | 24% |
| Yellow | 6 Lpm | 28% |
| White | 8 Lpm | 31% |
| Green | 12 Lpm | 35% |
| Pink | 15 Lpm | 40% |
| Orange | 15 Lpm | 50% |



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